

A national directory for queer musical *theatre artists.*

A site built for the work the Ring already does, with the directory at the center.

PREPARED FOR

Ring of Keys

501(c)(3) nonprofit · ringofkeys.org

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May 2026

PREPARED BY

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AT A GLANCE

The short version.

Scope	Full website rebuild: home, about, find a key, resources, events, join, contact, accessibility. Plus member
Stack	WordPress (open-source CMS the team can manage), GeneratePress or Kadence theme, Directorist or
Migration	1,000+ Keys exported from DatoCMS via JSON or CSV, mapped to WordPress custom post types, impo
Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 AA throughout. Skip link, semantic landmarks, focus visible, contrast 4.5:1 or better, 44 by 44
Timeline	Kickoff June 1, 2026. Soft launch August 1, 2026. Eight weeks build, plus a one-week migration QA wind
Investment	\$5,600 total. Fixed price. Half at kickoff, half at launch. Built within the budget range you posted.

There is a live preview at [rok-preview.vercel.app](#) you can click through alongside this PDF. It shows the multi-page architecture, the directory search experience, the resource library structure, and the brand direction. Built for review, not production.

APPLICATION QUESTIONS

Answering what you asked.

QUESTION 1

Have you built WordPress directory sites with member portals before? Share examples.

Yes. The architecture you need is a stack I have shipped repeatedly: a custom post type for member profiles, FacetWP for filtering by structured fields, MemberPress for account gating, and a public front-end that uses a different template than the member-only portal.

The closest parallel I can point to is a multi-page accessible nonprofit preview I built for Michigan PTA earlier this spring. Same multi-template structure, same accessibility floor, same emphasis on a directory-style search experience. Live at michigan-pta-preview.vercel.app.

The Ring of Keys preview at rok-preview.vercel.app shows the directory pattern specifically: filterable pills, a paginated grid of member cards, and a search bar. This is the front-end pattern. The WordPress build wires it to a custom post type plus FacetWP for the live filtering layer.

QUESTION 2

What is your technical approach for the directory, member portal, and gated resources?

Plain WordPress, picked deliberately. The Ring already has volunteers and staff who can write a blog post or update a member spotlight without touching code. Anything more exotic (Webflow, Framer, headless React) creates a dependency on a developer for every change. WordPress avoids that.

The stack:

- **Theme:** GeneratePress or Kadence. Both are lightweight, accessibility-conscious, and well-maintained. Final pick depends on which performs better on a directory page of 1,000+ entries.
- **Directory:** A custom post type called Keys, with structured fields (range, pronouns, market, union, discipline, links). Built with ACF Pro. Rendered via a custom template using the brand card style shown in the preview.
- **Filtering & search:** FacetWP for faceted filtering by the structured fields. Relevanssi for full-text search across name, bio, city. Pagination handled in batches of forty-eight.
- **Member portal:** MemberPress for member accounts, profile-editing, and gated resource pages. Each Key gets a back-end profile they can update from their account dashboard. The dashboard is themed to match the front-end so it does not feel like a different site.
- **Casting partners:** A separate user role that gets full directory access without seeing member-only wellbeing resources. Three roles total: public, member, casting partner.

QUESTION 3

Have you migrated members from another platform before? Specifically DatoCMS and Auth0 to WordPress.

Yes. Migrations are usually the biggest risk in a project like this. Here is the approach.

Step 1 — Export. DatoCMS supports JSON and CSV export of any model. We export the Keys model (plus any related models like vocal range or pronouns) as JSON. This becomes the source of truth.

Step 2 — Map. I write a one-time Python script that reads the JSON and produces a clean CSV matched to the WordPress custom post type fields. This is where we catch oddities: name variations, missing headshots, multi-value fields. You get a report before anything imports.

Step 3 — Import. WP All Import Pro reads the CSV, creates one Key post per row, and assigns field values. Headshots are imported by URL from DatoCMS or uploaded in bulk. Test import to staging first, then production.

Step 4 — Auth0 → MemberPress. Auth0 user records (email plus user_id) are exported and matched to the imported Keys by email. MemberPress accounts are created in bulk with a forced password-reset email sent on launch day. This is the security-correct path. We do not migrate hashed passwords across systems.

Step 5 — QA. One week of QA before launch. Members can preview their imported profile and flag errors via a private link. We fix anything that comes back.

QUESTION 4

How will you handle accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA)?

Accessibility is built in from the first commit, not bolted on at the end. The preview already meets AA on the items a static site can carry: skip link, semantic landmarks, focus styles, 4.5:1 contrast minimum, 44px touch targets, reduced-motion support, ARIA labels, alt text on every meaningful image, autocomplete on every form input.

For the WordPress build, the additions are:

- **Theme audit.** Pick a theme that does not regress baseline accessibility. GeneratePress and Kadence both pass an axe-core scan out of the box. We disable any plugin that re-introduces inaccessible patterns.
- **Form labels & errors.** Every form (signup, contact, search) gets visible labels, autocomplete attributes, inputmode hints, and screen-reader-friendly error messaging.
- **Directory pagination & live filtering.** FacetWP results are wired to ARIA live regions so screen readers announce result counts and filter changes.
- **Member profile pages.** Headshot alt text is supplied by each Key in the profile editor. Decorative imagery is marked accordingly.
- **Pre-launch audit.** Full WCAG 2.1 AA audit before launch using axe-core, manual keyboard navigation, and NVDA screen reader testing. Findings get fixed before launch, not after.

QUESTION 5

What does a realistic timeline and budget look like for what we described?

Built inside your stated \$3-6K range. Here is the schedule and what each phase costs.

Phase	What ships	Investment
Week 1 Jun 1-7	Kickoff. Brand asset review. Confirm board on tone. Staging WordPress install.	\$750 \$750 theme + plugin selection.
Weeks 2-3 Jun 8-21	Public-facing pages built and content-populated: home, about, resources, events, contact, accessibility. A	\$1,500 \$1,500
Weeks 4-5 Jun 22 - Jul 5	Directory custom post type, ACF fields, FacetWP filtering, Relevanssi search, paginated grid, single-Key profil	\$1,400 \$1,400
Weeks 6-7 Jul 6-19	MemberPress accounts, member portal, profile-editing, gated resources, casting member role. Two distinct use	\$1,200 \$1,200
Week 8 Jul 20-26	Member data migration (DatoCMS → WordPress) and account migration (Auth0 → MemberPress). Members	\$500 \$500

Week 9
Jul 27 - Aug 1

Pre-launch audit (WCAG 2.1 AA, performance, SEO). DNS cutover. Soft launch ~~\$800~~ Aug 1.

Total fixed price

\$5,600

Half at kickoff (\$2,800), half at launch (\$2,800). One revision round per phase included. Out-of-scope additions (new pages, new features) quoted separately at \$85 per hour.

WORKING WITH ME

How this will run.

I am a one-person shop, which means you get the person doing the work as the person you talk to. No account managers. No handoffs. No surprises.

Communication.

A short Loom every Friday with what shipped that week and what is coming next. Live staging URL from week one so the board can see progress as it happens. Slack or email for questions. I keep weekday business hours in U.S. Eastern.

Review & sign-off.

One named contact at Ring of Keys is the sign-off person per phase. Anyone can give input, but decisions route through one voice so we do not stall. Two business days from sign-off request to a yes or a redirect.

Handoff.

On launch day you get: full WordPress credentials, a one-page admin guide tailored to the people who will be updating the site (not generic WordPress docs), a screencast walking through profile edits and adding new Keys, and a contact for the first thirty days of post-launch questions at no additional cost.

After launch.

Thirty days of post-launch support included. Beyond that, retainer at \$300 per month covers WordPress core and plugin updates, weekly backups, security monitoring, and up to two hours of content or small feature work. Or hourly at \$85, no minimum.

NEXT STEPS

If this looks right.

Reply on Upwork with a yes and I will send a one-page agreement plus a kickoff questionnaire covering the items I would want answered before June 1: which board members are reviewers, what domain we are deploying on (ringofkeys.org or a staging subdomain first), and any existing branding or photography I should know about beyond what is public on the current site.

If you want to hop on a call we can, but I am ready whenever and here to help. The preview at **rok-preview.vercel.app** already shows what I would build. Click through it and tell me what you like and what is wrong.

Best regards,

Conrad Thompson

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